

Black sand, *warm skin*

Eighty frames for The Love Adventure and the For Her pages. Forty of you, forty of you and Mark. The whole day is built on one contrast: the hardest, darkest landscape in Auckland, and the warmest palette in your brand.

SOLO FRAMES	TOGETHER	TODAY	LOOKS	SHOOTING
40, S1 to S40	40, D1 to D40	10am to 12pm, about 35	7 changes	Wed 26 August, today

TODAY, WEDNESDAY 26 AUGUST · 10AM TO 12PM

Two hours gets you about 35 frames, not 80

Worth saying plainly before you drive: eighty frames is a full day, and you have a two hour window. What follows is the ruthless version. One wardrobe change, no falls track, everything inside two minutes of the main carpark. Shoot it in this order and you will come home with roughly 22 of the solo list and 15 of the together list, including most of the ones that matter.

TIDE Dropping all window	HIGH WAS 8.40am	LOW IS 2.25pm, after you go	SUN Northeast, climbing	SEA 13.5 degrees
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- 10.10

Waterline and wet sand
A dropping tide leaves a fresh mirror band the whole time you are there, so the reflection frames are on. Follow the water down. **S6, S7, S9, S8. D6, D9, D10, D11.**
- 10.35

Lion Rock base and the black rock
Tide is falling so the shelves keep opening up and staying safe. Hard mid morning side light, which is exactly what this block wants. **S12, S14, S16, S13. D14, D17, D12.**
- 11.00

Dunes and wind
The haircut block. Do not skip it, it is the reason for the trip. **S18, S21, S24, S19. D19, D20.**
- 11.20

The open sand, walking
Long lens down the beach so Lion Rock stacks up behind you. **S30, S31, S33. D29, D32, D33.**
- 11.40

Tailgate, blanket, thermos
Ends warm and it is right next to the car, so it absorbs any overrun. **S29, S25, S27. D23, D24, D26, D25.**

Turn your back on the sea for the pretty light

Between ten and twelve the sun is in the northeast and climbing, so Piha is lit from behind the land. Facing the water means flat frontal light on faces. Every glowing backlit frame on this list needs you to turn around and shoot inland, toward Lion Rock and the bush, with the sun up beyond it. That is the opposite of what feels right on a beach, so decide it now rather than on the sand.

What two hours cannot buy, and how to get it

Everything built on low sun is gone today: S33 at its best, S35 to S39, S38, S40, D31, D35 to D40. That includes D37, the signature couple frame, and S39, the strongest portrait on the list. They need one more trip, and only a short one. Forty five minutes at Piha starting at 5.10pm on any clear evening picks up all ten. Same clothes, same beach, one carpark.

Skipped on purpose, so nobody wonders

The Kitekite falls track is thirty five minutes each way and would eat the entire window, so block 1 is out. North Piha lagoon is a separate drive, so block 2 moves to the waterline in front of the main carpark instead. Both are worth doing on the return trip if you want them.

Move fast and cut in this order

If you are running behind, the tailgate block is the one to shorten, because it can happen anywhere on any day. Protect the dunes block and the waterline block. If you only get through two of the five, make them those two.

THE DIRECTION

Piha gives us Pine Deep for free

Your brand anchor is Pine Deep and the rule is that cream acts as relief, not the other way round. Piha does that for us in the landscape. The iron sand, the wet rock, the water under cloud: all of it sits in that dark green black range without any help. So we do not have to build the mood. We only have to put the warm thing in the frame.

That warm thing is you. Cream, oatmeal, camel, rust and terracotta all sing off black sand in a way they never do off a studio backdrop, and terracotta stays exactly where the guidelines want it, an accent inside a dark field rather than a wash. Every frame in this list is built the same way: dark ground, warm skin, one lit person, wide horizon behind.

The haircut is the reason to shoot here *now*. Piha is windy nearly every day of the year, and long hair on that beach means a whole day of fighting

BEFORE THE DAY

The eight things that decide whether this works

Most of these are booked or packed before anyone picks up a camera. The tide one changes the date, so settle it first.

Pick the date off the tide, not the diary Book a day where low tide falls between about 3pm and 5.30pm. That is the only way the mirror sand and the long light land together, and half the strongest frames in this list need both. Check the tide tables for Manukau Heads, which is the reference port for Piha. If the tide is wrong, move the date.	Piha water is the most dangerous in the country Nobody goes past ankle depth, including for the sunset frames. Do not put anyone or a camera bag on the Taitomo rocks or near The Gap if there is any swell running. Check the surf forecast the night before. If it is big, we lose two frames and keep everyone, which is a fine trade.
Late winter light means no dead hour The sun barely gets above 35 degrees in Auckland at this time of year, so there is no harsh midday to hide from. That is why this plan works straight through from 7am with only a short break. Sunset is around 5.45pm, and the carpark goes properly dark fast afterwards, so pack the torch.	Black sand lies to the light meter A frame full of iron sand pushes the meter to overexpose, and you get grey mush where the sand should be rich. Dial in two thirds to one and a third of a stop under, expose for her skin, and let the sand sit dark. Read the histogram, not the screen. On a bright beach the screen will tell you it is fine when it is a stop hot.
Iron sand is magnetic and it is abrasive No lens changes anywhere on the sand. Two bodies if you have them, one long and one wide, and tape the seams. Sea spray gives free diffusion when shooting into the sun, which is a gift, but check the front element every ten frames and keep the cloth in a zip bag so it stays dry.	Wardrobe: cream and rust, never head to toe black Cream, oatmeal, camel, rust, terracotta and pine green all separate beautifully from black sand. Head to toe black sinks into it, so keep black for the deliberate silhouettes in block seven. No pure white, it clips before the skin does. No logos and no fine busy prints, they moire. Fabric that moves is worth more than fabric that fits.
A kit list that is mostly not camera kit Wool blanket that doubles as a prop, thermos, two towels, spare socks, a bin liner to sit on, a fine brush for sand in hair, a comb, texture paste, lip balm, a torch, and dry clothes for the drive home. Cold and wind will end the day early if nobody plans for them, and the last two blocks are the best two.	Ask for the crops up front Eighty finals graded warm, plus flat ungraded versions of the ten hero frames so the site build can crop and colour without fighting a bake. Every frame flagged for social needs 4:5 and 9:16 as well as the master. And at least twelve frames with deliberate empty space on one side, because headlines have to sit somewhere.

THE DAY

Eight blocks, following the light

Tap any shot to tick it off on the day. Shot numbers are the names to call out loud, so S18 and D29 mean the same thing to everyone standing on the sand.

BLOCK 1 7.00 Glen Esk bush and the Kitekite track

LIGHT

Mist and filtered green, no wind, very soft

LOOK 1

Her: cream linen shirt over camel. Him: oatmeal knit, dark trousers. Boots.

LENS

85mm mostly, 35mm for the track

JUST YOU

☐ S1 Standing in the nikau gap

VERTICAL · THREE QUARTER · 85MM

Stand in the break between two nikau trunks with the light behind you. Look off to camera left, not at me. Weight on the back foot so the shoulders open.

FOR *Meet Tarisha, About*

☐ S2 Hand on the punga trunk

VERTICAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Palm flat on the trunk, chin turned away so the cut reads in profile against the dark bush. Slow blink, then open.

FOR *Course module cards*

☐ S3 Walking the track toward camera

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM · COPY SPACE RIGHT

Walk at me watching your feet, then look up on three. Keep walking after the look. The frame we want is the one two steps later.

FOR *For Her homepage hero*

☐ S4 Small on the stream boulder

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 35MM

You sit, I back off until you are about a fifth of the frame. All green, one warm figure. Do nothing at all.

FOR *Quiet page bands, email header*

☐ S5 Close portrait in the mist

VERTICAL · HEAD AND SHOULDERS · 135MM WIDE OPEN

Eyes to lens, mouth soft, no teeth. Think about one client you actually like. This is the trust frame, so it lives or dies on the eyes.

FOR *Quiz opt in, podcast art*

YOU AND MARK

☐ D1 She leads, his hand at her back

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · FROM BEHIND AND OFF TO THE SIDE

Walk the track, you slightly ahead, his hand resting at the small of your back. Neither of you looks back. This is the grounded and radiant shape in one frame.

FOR *Homepage hero, Wanaka retreat*

☐ D2 The pause, foreheads touching

VERTICAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Stop mid track, foreheads together, eyes closed, one slow breath in together. Hold it three breaths, I shoot all three.

FOR *Couples therapy hero*

☐ D3 Crossing the stream stones

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM

He goes first and turns back with a hand out. Both of you look at the water, not at each other and not at me. The concentration is the point.

FOR *Intensives page*

☐ D4 On the log, same direction

HORIZONTAL · THREE QUARTER · 50MM

Sit shoulder to shoulder on the fallen log, both looking the same way at the same thing. Talk about something ordinary. I want the version where neither of you is performing.

FOR *About us*

☐ D5 She says something, he laughs

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 85MM · BURST

Tell him the thing you would actually tell him. I shoot the whole laugh and I keep the frames after the peak, because the settle is warmer than the peak.

FOR *Testimonials band, social*

BLOCK 2 8.30 North Piha lagoon and the mirror sand

LIGHT

Low side sun or flat cloud, both work, reflection is the subject

LOOK 2

Her: rust or terracotta, cream knit. Him: charcoal and camel. Bare feet.

NOTE

Camera almost on the sand for every reflection frame. Bring the bin liner.

JUST YOU

☐ S6 Standing in your own reflection

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · DEAD CENTRE, SYMMETRICAL

Feet in a centimetre of water. Straight to camera, arms loose, chin level. Perfectly still so the water goes glassy. Count ten seconds without moving.

FOR *Course sales page hero*

☐ S7 The reflection alone

HORIZONTAL · CAMERA ON THE SAND · YOU CROPPED AT THE KNEE

Same position. I frame the upside down you and cut the actual you off above. Odd, beautiful, and it gives the site an art frame that is not a portrait.

FOR *Dark section art*

☐ S8 Walking through the shallows, side on

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · PANNING · 1/60

Walk parallel to me through ankle water, no stopping, five passes. Skirt moving, water moving, you steady in the middle of it.

FOR *Reels covers, 9:16 crop*

☐ S9 The turn

VERTICAL · CHEST UP · 135MM · BURST

Face away, then turn your head to me on a count. Ten times. I shoot the middle of the turn, not the end, so the hair is still moving. This is the haircut frame.

FOR *Social, YouTube thumbnails*

☐ S10 Arms open into the light

HORIZONTAL · THREE QUARTER · 50MM

Chin up, eyes closed, arms out low and relaxed rather than up and triumphant. Low arms read as ease. High arms read as a stock photo.

FOR *Course page, the after section*

☐ S11 Sitting at the water line, knees up

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM

Arms around your knees, looking out at the Tasman. Not sad, just quiet. Give it a minute before I start shooting.

FOR *Blog headers, page breaks*

YOU AND MARK

☐ D6 Two reflections closing the gap

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · LOW CAMERA · THREE FRAMES

Start ten metres apart in the mirror and walk toward each other. I take it at ten metres, at three, and at touch. Both reflections in the water the whole way.

FOR *Homepage hero*

☐ D7 Facing each other, hands on forearms

VERTICAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Hands gripping each other's forearms, eyes on eyes, nobody talks.

Twenty seconds of it. The discomfort passes at about eight seconds and that is when I shoot.

FOR *Couples therapy page*

☐ D8 He lifts her, both laughing

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM · FAST SHUTTER

Actual lift, actual spin, water underfoot. Do it twice. The second one is always looser than the first.

FOR *Events, Connection Playground*

☐ D9 Backs to camera, a gap between you

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · SMALL IN A BIG FRAME

Both looking out at the sea, standing about thirty centimetres apart. Do not touch. This is the picture of the sentence you already use on the site.

FOR *Homepage dark band*

Pairs with D10. Same framing, tripod locked, do not move the camera.

☐ D10 The same frame, hands found

HORIZONTAL · IDENTICAL FRAMING TO D9

Nothing changes except the hands find each other. Shot from the locked off camera so the two run side by side on the page.

FOR *Therapy page, the before and after pair*

Half of the strongest idea on this list. Do not skip it.

☐ D11 Walking away through the mirror

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 35MM

Hand in hand, walking away, footprints and two reflections trailing behind you. Keep walking until I call it. The further you get the better it works.

FOR *Retreat closing band, footer*

BLOCK 3 10.15 Lion Rock and the black rock shelves

LIGHT

Harder now, use it. Side light on rock, deep shadow behind.

LOOK 3

Her: pine green or deep charcoal coat over cream. Him: dark. Boots on, this block has climbing in it.

NOTE

This is the credibility block. Two therapists who know what they are doing.

JUST YOU

☐ S12 Against the black rock wall

VERTICAL · WAIST UP · 85MM · HARD SIDE LIGHT

Shoulders back on the rock, face lifted into the light, one hand at your side not on your hip. Let the rock be almost black behind you.

FOR *About, credibility band*

☐ S13 Tiny on the rock shelf

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 24MM · HUGE NEGATIVE SPACE

You stand, I get very far back and very low. The headline goes in the rock face, so leave me the whole left of the frame.

FOR *Hero banner with copy over*

☐ S14 Arms crossed, no smile

VERTICAL · CHEST UP · 85MM

Straight down the lens, mouth closed, nothing softening it. You are allowed to look like an authority. Give me ten frames without apologising for any of them.

FOR *Podcast cover, press, speaking*

☐ S15 Mid step, climbing

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM

Actual effort on an actual step up, hand on rock, weight committed. Not a posed foot on a boulder. Do the move properly and I shoot it three times.

FOR *Intensives, the this is work section*

☐ S16 Profile against sky

VERTICAL · HEAD AND SHOULDERS · 135MM · SKY ONLY BEHIND

Top of the steps, pure profile, nothing behind you but light. Rim light along the jaw and the back of the cut. The cleanest possible record of the shape of the hair.

FOR *Section markers, the cut in profile*

☐ S17 In the rock cleft, looking down

HORIZONTAL · THREE QUARTER · 50MM

Sit into the gap in the rock, coat pulled around you, eyes down. An honest frame with no performance in it. Every site needs one.

FOR *Blog, quiet writing*

YOU AND MARK

☐ D12 He stands, she leans on his leg

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM

You sit on the shelf, back against his shin, his hand resting on your shoulder. Both looking out to sea. This is the portrait version of how you actually work together.

FOR *About us portrait*

☐ D13 The hand up

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM · MID PULL

He is up, you are not yet. Actual weight through the arms. Shoot the middle of the pull, not the arrival.

FOR *Intensives hero*

☐ D14 Shoulder to shoulder, straight to lens

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Both serious, both level, no touching. The two therapists frame. It has to be able to sit next to a price and hold its ground.

FOR *Credibility band, retreat page*

☐ D15 Backs on the rock, heads turned in

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 85MM · HARD LIGHT

Both leaning back on the wall, heads turned toward each other, almost a smile on one of you and not the other. Half a conversation.

FOR *Dark section, sticky bar thumbnail*

☐ D16 Two of you under Lion Rock

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 24MM

Both tiny, rock enormous, sky above for the headline. Walk slowly across so I get three positions in the frame.

FOR *Full bleed hero*

☐ D17 Her hand on his chest, his over hers

VERTICAL · CHIN TO WAIST · 85MM · NO FACES

Crop the heads off deliberately. Two hands, one chest, breathing. Anonymous, so it can carry any page including the ones about other people's marriages.

FOR *Therapy page, safe anywhere*

BLOCK 4 12.00 The dunes, spinifex and full wind

LIGHT

Midday, but low enough in winter to stay usable. Backlight where you can.

LOOK 4

Her: long cream or oatmeal dress with movement in it, bare feet. Him: cream shirt open over a tee.

NOTE

The flagship block for the course pages. No reflectors, they turn into sails.

JUST YOU

☐ S18 Standing into the wind

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · 85MM

In the spinifex, wind full on the face, chin into it, hands down. Do not fix anything. Dress and hair pushed hard. If we only get one frame all day, it is this one.

FOR *Course hero, the flagship*

☐ S19 Laughing at the wind

VERTICAL · THREE QUARTER · 85MM

Same spot, but let it be funny. It is genuinely ridiculous out there. That is the warmth version of S18.

FOR *Social, warmth*

☐ S20 Lying back in the dune hollow

HORIZONTAL · FROM DIRECTLY ABOVE · 35MM

Out of the wind, down in the hollow, sand and grass around your face, eyes closed, one arm above your head. I shoot straight down.

FOR *Course, the body and rest section*

☐ S21 Hands in your hair, elbows up

VERTICAL · CHEST UP · 85MM

Both hands back through the cut, elbows wide, eyes down and then up to me. The definitive haircut frame. Ten of these.

FOR *The haircut announcement, everywhere*

☐ S22 Running down the dune face

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 1/1000, THEN ONE AT 1/30

Run properly, sand flying. Two versions: frozen, then one deliberately blurred. The blurred one usually wins.

FOR *Reels cover, freedom*

☐ S23 Walking the dune ridge, side on

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 135MM · SKY BEHIND

Along the top of the ridge with nothing but sky behind. Expose for skin or you get a silhouette by accident. Two passes.

FOR *Wide banners*

☐ S24 Hair across the face, one eye clear

VERTICAL · TIGHT · 135MM · EMPTY RIGHT THIRD

Let the wind put hair across your face and do not clear it. One eye visible and locked on the lens. Leave the right third of the frame empty for thumbnail text.

FOR *YouTube thumbnails*

YOU AND MARK

☐ D18 In the hollow, his chin on her head

VERTICAL · THREE QUARTER · 50MM

You sit between his legs in the hollow, out of the wind, his chin resting on top of your head, both looking the same way. Ease, not romance.

FOR *Homepage warmth band*

☐ D19 Both on the ridge, hands linked low

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 85MM

Walk the ridge together into the wind, hands linked down low rather than raised. Shirt and hair moving, nobody fixing anything.

FOR *Retreat hero*

☐ D20 He holds her hair out of her face

VERTICAL · CHEST UP · 85MM

Let it actually happen, then let it be funny. The most human frame of the day and probably the one you end up loving.

FOR *About us, social*

☐ D21 Back to back, looking opposite ways

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM

Sitting in the sand, spines touching, each looking a different way. Not a fight. Two people holding each other up while facing separate directions.

FOR *Therapy page, the honest one*

☐ D22 She whispers, he closes his eyes

VERTICAL · WAIST UP · TIGHT · 135MM

Say something to him quietly. Whatever it is, I do not need to hear it. I need his face when he does.

FOR *Intimacy section, course cross sell*

BLOCK 5 2.30 The car boot, the blanket, the thermos

LIGHT

Whatever it is doing. Shoot it documentary, no styling.

LOOK 5

Same clothes as block 4 plus coats and the wool blanket. Salt in the hair now, which is correct.

NOTE

This is lunch. Eat, and let the camera be there while you do.

JUST YOU

☐ S25 Pouring from the thermos

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 50MM · STEAM VISIBLE

Backlight the steam. You are not looking at me and you are not aware of me. Just pour the tea.

FOR *Blog, email, the ordinary woman frame*

☐ S26 On the tailgate, boots swinging

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM

Sit on the open boot, heels knocking the bumper, cup in both hands. Talk to me while I shoot and I will catch the between moments.

FOR *About, podcast episode art*

☐ S27 Head back, laughing, cup in hand

VERTICAL · CHEST UP · 85MM · BURST

Whatever makes you laugh properly, do that. I want the one where your eyes have gone completely.

FOR *Social, joy*

☐ S28 Reading your own notebook

HORIZONTAL · THREE QUARTER · FROM THE SIDE · 85MM

Your actual notebook, your actual handwriting, glasses on if you wear them. This is the frame that says a decade of clinical practice without saying it.

FOR *Course page, credibility*

☐ S29 Blanket round the shoulders, straight to lens

VERTICAL · CHEST UP · 85MM

Pull the wool up round your shoulders and look right at me. Cold cheeks, warm eyes. The single best frame you can put above an email sign up box.

FOR *Quiz opt in, newsletter*

YOU AND MARK

☐ D23 One cup, passed across

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 50MM

Share the one cup. The handover is the frame. Do it four or five times while you talk about something else.

FOR *Email header, social*

☐ D24 Under one blanket, looking out

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · FROM BEHIND · 35MM

Both on the tailgate under the same blanket, backs to me, watching the sea. Say nothing for a while. I will wait.

FOR *Homepage, quiet band*

☐ D25 He wipes the sand off her foot

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · LOW · 35MM

Exactly what it says. Small, practical, tender, nobody performing. Care looks like this and not like a kiss on a clifftop.

FOR *Therapy page, the care frame*

☐ D26 Both laughing at something off camera

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Not at each other, at a third thing. The shared attention is warmer than the eye contact and it is much harder to fake.

FOR *About us, social*

☐ D27 He turns away, she watches him

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM · LOCKED OFF

No acting. He simply walks a few steps away and stops. You stay and watch him. That is all. The camera does not move.

FOR *Therapy page, the problem section*

Pairs with D28. Same lens, same spot, camera locked.

☐ D28 Thirty seconds later, the repair

HORIZONTAL · IDENTICAL FRAMING TO D27

He turns back. You are already reaching. Same frame, so the two sit next to each other and say the whole thing your work says.

FOR *Therapy page, paired with D27*

The other half of the strongest idea on this list.

BLOCK 6 3.45 The long sweep of beach, low sun

LIGHT

The good hour. Backlit, hazy, sea spray doing the diffusion for us.

LOOK 6

Her: terracotta or rust knit, cream wide trousers. Him: oatmeal knit.

LENS

135mm for nearly all of it. Compression puts Lion Rock right behind you.

JUST YOU

☐ S30 Walking at camera, Lion Rock behind

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 135MM · LONG COMPRESSION

Start a long way off and walk at me without stopping. Do not think about your face. The rock will stack up huge behind you.

FOR *For Her hero, the confident walk*

☐ S31 Stopped, hands in pockets, half smile

VERTICAL · THREE QUARTER · 135MM · RIM LIT

Stop where you are and put your hands in your pockets. Sun behind you so the edge of the cut lights up. Half a smile, not a full one.

FOR *Homepage portrait slot*

☐ S32 On the driftwood, one knee up

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM

Coat open, one knee up, elbow on it. Comfortable and a bit sprawled. Not ladylike, which is rather the point of the whole brand.

FOR *Blog, podcast*

☐ S33 Backlit close, through the spray haze

VERTICAL · HEAD AND SHOULDERS · 135MM WIDE OPEN

Sun directly behind your head, salt haze in the air, everything glowing and soft. Eyes to lens. This is the portrait that goes at the top of the course page.

FOR *Course page hero portrait*

☐ S34 Writing in the wet sand with a toe

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM

Write whatever you like, looking down at it. Playful and unposed, and it gives the social feed something that is not a portrait.

FOR *Social*

YOU AND MARK

☐ D29 Walking at camera together, mid conversation

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 135MM

Long walk straight at me, talking the whole way, never looking at the lens. Three passes. This is most likely the homepage hero, so give it the time.

FOR *Homepage hero, main frame*

☐ D30 He spins her, sand kicking up

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM · FAST SHUTTER

Low sun catches the kicked sand and it turns gold. Two goes only, it is hard work in sand.

FOR *Events, Connection Playground*

☐ D31 On the driftwood, legs over his

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 85MM

Your legs across his lap, foreheads close, both talking. Twenty years of ease in the posture. Let me shoot for two full minutes without directing.

FOR *Retreat page*

☐ D32 A kiss on the temple, backlit

VERTICAL · CHEST UP · 135MM · RIM THROUGH THE HAIR

Not on the mouth. On the temple, your eyes closed. Restraint reads as long love. A mouth kiss reads as an engagement shoot.

FOR *Homepage, the tender one*

☐ D33 Both to camera, squinting into the sun

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Arms round each other, low sun in your faces, both squinting and laughing about it. Slightly imperfect on purpose. This is the honest About us frame.

FOR *About us*

☐ D34 The two of you and the whole beach

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 24MM · COPY SPACE

Right back. Lion Rock, the full sweep of sand, the sun, and two small figures. Leave the top half of the frame clear for a headline.

FOR *Full bleed banner, retreat hero*

BLOCK 7 5.00 Sunset into the Tasman

LIGHT

Straight into it. Expose for the sky and let the bodies go to shape.

LOOK 7

Dark now: pine, charcoal, coats. This is the one block where head to toe dark is right.

NOTE

Forty five minutes, no more. Work fast and keep to the plan.

JUST YOU

☐ S35 Full silhouette, sun behind your head

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · 85MM · EXPOSED FOR SKY

Line the sun up directly behind your head. Stand still, arms clear of the body so the outline reads. Pure shape, no face.

FOR *Dark Pine sections, quote backgrounds*

☐ S36 One step across, face catches

VERTICAL · THREE QUARTER · 85MM

Step sideways so the sun sits just off your shoulder. Suddenly the face is lit and the rest stays dark. Best of both in one frame.

FOR *Hero*

☐ S37 Sun flare through your fingers

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 50MM · STOPPED DOWN FOR THE STARBURST

Hand up, sun broken through the gaps in your fingers. Decorative, and it gives the designer something to layer text over.

FOR *Social, decorative*

☐ S38 Ankle deep, back to camera, facing the sun

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 85MM

Ankle deep and no further. Back to me, facing the last of it. This is the frame for the line you already use, the deepest love is still ahead of you.

FOR *Closing band, both sites*

☐ S39 The last orange light on your face

VERTICAL · HEAD AND SHOULDERS · 135MM

Turn into the final few minutes of colour and look at me. Nothing else in the frame. If the day gives one great portrait, it will be this one or S33.

FOR *Podcast cover, press, the signature portrait*

YOU AND MARK

☐ D35 Two silhouettes closing to touch

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · THREE FRAMES

Apart, closer, touching. Keep a clear gap of sky between your outlines at every stage or it turns into one blob.

FOR *Dark band, homepage*

☐ D36 The lift, in silhouette

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 85MM

He lifts, your arms go out. Read entirely as shape against the orange. Joy without a single visible face.

FOR *Events, joy*

☐ D37 Foreheads together, sun between your chests

VERTICAL · WAIST UP · 135MM

Foreheads touching, bodies angled so the sun burns through the gap between your chests. Move a few centimetres at a time until the light finds the hole. Worth five minutes on its own.

FOR *The signature couple frame, homepage hero*

☐ D38 Walking into the sun, long shadows behind

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM

Backs to me, walking toward the water, shadows stretching back at the camera. Keep going until you are small.

FOR *Closing band, footer*

☐ D39 Sitting in the wet sand, reflected

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · LOW CAMERA · 50MM

Sit down in the wet sand, lean into each other, let the last colour reflect underneath you. You will get wet. It is the last block, it is fine.

FOR *Retreat page*

BLOCK 8

5.50

Blue hour, then home

LIGHT

Cold blue ambient, plus one warm source from the side. A torch or the car headlights will do it.

LOOK 8

Coats, the blanket, whatever is warm. Two frames only.

NOTE

Warm source at 45 degrees, low ISO discipline, then stop and go and get dinner.

JUST YOU

☐ S40

Wrapped in the blanket, blue and warm

VERTICAL · THREE QUARTER · 50MM · WARM LIGHT FROM CAMERA LEFT

Blanket round you at the water's edge, cold blue everywhere and one warm light on your face. Genuinely cold, which will show, and that is what makes it good.

FOR Podcast, blog, the moody one

YOU AND MARK

☐ D40

One blanket, empty beach, faces close

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Both inside the one blanket, faces close, nobody left on the beach. The last frame of the day and the most intimate. Then we all go home.

FOR Newsletter, retreat, the closing frame

WHERE THEY GO

Every page slot, and the frames that fill it

Built against what is live now: the homepage and Together pages on theloveadventure.com, the mini course and workshop, and the Desire Blueprint quiz opt in.

PAGE OR ASSET	FIRST CHOICE	BACK UPS
theloveadventure.com homepage hero	D29, D37	D6, D1, D34
Homepage dark band, the lonely line	D9	D24, D35, D38
About us	D33, D12	D4, D20, D26
Couples therapy page	D2, D7	D17, D21, D25
Therapy page, the problem and the repair	D27 + D28	D9 + D10
Intensives, The New Chapter of Us	D13, D3	D15, D22
Wanaka retreat	D19, D34	D1, D31, D39
Events and Connection Playground	D8, D30	D36, D5
Two therapists credibility band	D14	D12, D16
For Her homepage hero	S30, S3	S31, S18
Sexual confidence mini course, hero	S33, S18	S6, S10
Course module cards and inner sections	S2, S20, S28	S10, S17, S32
Desire Blueprint quiz, opt in	S29, S5	S27, S31
Workshop page	S19, S27	S26, S34
Podcast cover and episode art	S39, S14	S26, S40, S5
YouTube thumbnails	S24, S21	S9, S27
Reels and TikTok covers, 9:16	S8, S22	S19, S9, S18
Email headers and newsletter	S25, D23	S4, D40
Blog and quiet page breaks	S11, S17	S4, S32, S37
Full bleed banners with headline over	S13, D16	D34, S23, S35
Footer and closing bands	S38, D38	D11, D35

Twelve frames are deliberately built with empty space for headlines: S3, S4, S13, S23, S24, S34, D9, D11, D16, D34, D35, D38.

IF THE DAY GOES SIDEWAYS

The ten frames worth losing everything else for

Rain, a blown out forecast, a shorter day than planned. Shoot these and the sites still get built.

- S18 standing into the wind, and S33 backlit close through the haze. One is the course, the other is the portrait everything else hangs off.
- S39 the last light on your face. The single strongest solo portrait if the sunset shows up.
- S21 hands through the cut. The whole reason for the day.
- S29 blanket round the shoulders, straight to lens. It sells the opt in on its own.
- D29 the walk toward camera. Most likely homepage hero.
- D37 foreheads together with the sun burning between you. The signature couple frame.
- D9 and D10 the gap and the hands found, same locked off frame. Two pictures that say what your work does.
- D14 shoulder to shoulder, straight to lens, serious. The frame that has to sit next to a retreat price.

Rain is not a reason to cancel. Piha in rain gives wet black rock, low cloud on the ridge and an empty beach, and blocks 1, 3 and 5 all work better in it. Only wind over about 40 knots or a big swell is worth moving the date for.